The Big Picture

Getting the first job is a process with five gates. Know each gate before you start.

1 Big picture | 2 Pick a role | 3 Skills | 4 Projects | 5 Resume + profile | 6 Hiring rounds | 7 90-day plan | 8 Apply + next step

Every company follows roughly this path

Apply
Naukri, LinkedIn, career pages, referrals, campus

Resume screen
ATS software + recruiter, about 10 seconds

Online test
Aptitude + reasoning + coding

Technical interview
Basics, your projects, problem solving

HR interview
Communication, attitude, fit

So you need five things

What a fresher needs to get hired

1. **A clear role** — One target, not five
2. **Core skills** — Basics done well
3. **3 projects** — Proof you can build
4. **Resume + profiles** — ATS resume, LinkedIn, GitHub
5. **Test + interview prep** — Aptitude, technical, HR

Each round, in one line

Round	What they check	What you need
Resume screen	Right keywords, clean format, projects	ATS-friendly 1-page resume (Step 5)
Online test	Speed + accuracy in aptitude, basic coding	Daily aptitude practice (Step 6)
Technical	Do you understand what you wrote on the resume?	Strong basics + 3 projects you can explain
HR	Can you communicate? Will you stay and learn?	Prepared answers, simple confident English

The good news: freshers are not expected to know everything. They are expected to know the basics well, show projects, and communicate clearly.

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Write down where you are today on each of the five things above: done, started, or not started.

Pick ONE Role

The biggest fresher mistake: learning a bit of everything and being ready for nothing.

Fresher-friendly roles

Role	What you do	Core skills	Good fit if you...
Frontend Developer	Build the screens users see	HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React	like design + logic together
Backend Developer	Build APIs, logic, databases	Node.js / Java / Python, SQL, APIs	like logic and data more than visuals
Full Stack Developer	Frontend + backend of a full app	MERN or similar stack, Git, deployment	want to build complete products
Data Analyst	Turn data into reports and decisions	Excel, SQL, Python, Power BI	like numbers, patterns and business
UI/UX Designer	Design how apps look and feel	Figma, design basics, user research	are creative and notice details
AI / ML Engineer	Build models and AI features	Python, maths basics, ML libraries, LLM APIs	enjoy maths and experiments
Software Tester (QA)	Find bugs before users do	Manual testing, test cases, Selenium basics	are careful and patient

How to choose in one evening

ASK 1
What do I enjoy?
- logic, visuals, data, people

→

ASK 2
What can I learn in 90 days?
- start from your current skills

→

ASK 3
Who is hiring freshers?
- check 20 job posts on Naukri / LinkedIn

→

DECIDE
Pick ONE role
- commit for 90 days

Avoid: switching roles every month because of a YouTube video. Depth beats variety for a first job.

Non-CS student? Data Analyst, UI/UX and Software Testing are the easiest entry points. Many companies hire any degree for these.

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Open 20 job posts for your chosen role. Note the 5 skills that appear most. That is your skill list for Step 3.

The Skills You Actually Need

Not 30 technologies. The basics every company checks, plus a short list for your role.

Every fresher, every role

- ☐ **One programming language** well (variables, loops, functions, arrays, objects)
- ☐ **Git + GitHub**: commit, push, branch, pull request
- ☐ **SQL basics**: SELECT, WHERE, JOIN, GROUP BY
- ☐ **Problem solving**: 1-2 easy coding problems a day
- ☐ **Communication**: explain your project in 2 minutes in simple English
- ☐ **Tools**: VS Code, Chrome DevTools, Excel / Sheets, Google Docs

Plus, for your role

Role	Must know	Good to have
Frontend	HTML, CSS, Flexbox/Grid, JavaScript (ES6), React, responsive design	Tailwind, TypeScript, Next.js
Backend	Node.js + Express (or Java Spring / Python Django), REST APIs, SQL, auth	MongoDB, Docker basics
Full Stack	Frontend + backend skills above, connecting both, deployment	Cloud basics, CI/CD
Data Analyst	Excel (pivot, lookup), SQL, Python (pandas), Power BI / Tableau, statistics basics	Storytelling with dashboards
UI/UX	Figma, layout, typography, colour, wireframes, prototypes, user flows	Basic HTML/CSS, usability testing
AI / ML	Python, NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, model evaluation, LLM API basics	Deep learning basics, prompt design

How deep? deep enough to build a project without copying a tutorial line by line. That is the fresher bar.

Free to learn: official docs, freeCodeCamp, YouTube full courses, W3Schools, Kaggle Learn (data), Figma community (design).

Soft skills companies quietly check

- ☐ Speak clearly for 2 minutes about yourself
- ☐ Write a polite, error-free email
- ☐ Ask questions when stuck
- ☐ Finish what you start, on time
- ☐ Take feedback without arguing

Certificates: worth it or not?

Worth it	Skip
Free certificates tied to a project you built	Ten certificates with no project
Internship certificate with real work	Paid "guaranteed job" certificates
Cloud / tool basics for your role	Courses you never finished

Learning order (do not jump ahead)

1. **Language basics** — 2-3 weeks
2. **Git + small project** — 1 week
3. **Main tool / framework** — 3-4 weeks
4. **Database + API / analysis** — 2-3 weeks
5. **Deploy + polish** — 1 week

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Tick what you already know. Plan 2 hours a day on the first unticked skill.

The 3-Projects Rule

Projects are your experience. Three good ones beat ten copied ones.

Build three, each bigger than the last

PROJECT 1
Small
- 1 week
- one feature done well
- e.g. to-do app, landing page, sales dashboard

→

PROJECT 2
Medium
- 2-3 weeks
- login, database, API
- e.g. expense tracker, blog, Figma app case study

→

PROJECT 3
Real-world
- 3-4 weeks
- solves a real problem
- e.g. job portal, clinic booking, college event app

A project recruiters like

- ☐ Solves a real problem, not only a tutorial copy
- ☐ Live link (Vercel, Netlify, GitHub Pages) or a video demo
- ☐ Clean README with screenshots
- ☐ You can explain every line in the interview
- ☐ Shows the skills from your job posts

Interview truth: most technical rounds for freshers spend half the time on your projects. "Why did you use this?" is the favourite question.

Ideas by role

Role	Project ideas that impress
Frontend	Movie search app with an API · Responsive portfolio · E-commerce UI with cart
Backend / Full Stack	Job portal with login · Expense tracker with charts · URL shortener with analytics
Data Analyst	Sales dashboard in Power BI · Cricket stats analysis · Customer churn report
UI/UX	Redesign a local app · Food delivery case study · College app user research
AI / ML	Resume screener · Chatbot on your own notes · Price prediction with a clean report

README template (copy it)

```
# Expense Tracker
Track daily spending and see where money goes.

Live: expense-tracker.vercel.app
Tech: React, Node.js, MongoDB, Chart.js

## Features
- Add, edit, delete expenses
- Monthly charts by category
- Login with JWT

## Screenshots
[image]

## What I learned
Auth, REST APIs, charts
```

Explain any project in 60 seconds

1 — PROBLEM
What problem?
- "Students lose track of spending"

2 — BUILD
What did you build?
- features + tech, one line each

3 — HARD
What was hard?
- one bug or decision you solved

4 — RESULT
Result
- live link, users, what you learned

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Pick your Project 1 today and write its one-line goal in a notebook.

Resume, LinkedIn and GitHub

Your resume gets you the call. LinkedIn and GitHub make recruiters believe it.

ATS resume checklist

- ☐ 1 page, single column, simple font (ATS reads it)
- ☐ Top: name, phone, email, LinkedIn, GitHub, portfolio
- ☐ Short summary: role + skills + what you built
- ☐ Skills section with the keywords from job posts
- ☐ Projects: what, tech used, one result each
- ☐ Education, certifications, achievements
- ☐ Saved as PDF named Firstname_Lastname_Resume.pdf

Never put on a fresher resume

- ☐ Photos, tables, 2 columns, icons (ATS breaks them)
- ☐ Spelling mistakes
- ☐ "Hardworking, team player" with no proof
- ☐ Skills you cannot answer questions on

LinkedIn checklist

- ☐ Clear photo + banner with your role
- ☐ Headline: Role | Skills | Open to ...
- ☐ About: who you are, what you built, what you want
- ☐ Featured: portfolio, best project, resume
- ☐ 10+ skills, 2-3 posts a week about what you learn

GitHub checklist

- ☐ Profile README with your intro + skills
- ☐ Pin your 3 projects
- ☐ Each repo has a README with screenshots + live link
- ☐ Commit a little most days (green squares help)

The 1-page resume layout (top to bottom)

Section	What to write	Lines
Header	Name · phone · email · LinkedIn · GitHub · portfolio	2
Summary	Role + 3 skills + best project + what you want	2-3
Skills	Languages · frameworks · tools · databases (keywords from job posts)	3-4
Projects	3 projects: name + tech + 2 bullet points with results + live link	9-12
Education	Degree, college, year, CGPA (if 7+), 12th / 10th optional	3
Extras	Internship, certifications, achievements, hackathons	3-4

One resume per role: change the summary and skills order for each job post. Same you, better keyword match.

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Update your resume after every project. Never wait until a job post appears.

The Hiring Rounds

What to expect in each round and how to prepare for it.

Online test

Section	Typical topics	Practise
Quantitative	Percentages, profit & loss, ratio, time & work, speed, averages	15-20 questions a day with a timer
Logical reasoning	Series, coding-decoding, blood relations, directions, syllogisms	10 a day, learn the pattern types
Verbal	Grammar, vocabulary, reading comprehension	1 article a day + error-spotting
Coding	1-2 easy/medium problems: arrays, strings, loops	One problem a day on any platform

Technical round: be ready for

- ☐ Basics of your language (OOP, data types, loops)
- ☐ Your 3 projects: why, how, what was hard
- ☐ SQL queries and DBMS basics
- ☐ Data structures: array, string, stack, queue, linked list
- ☐ OS + networking basics (process, thread, HTTP, DNS)
- ☐ Write simple code on paper or a shared screen

Golden rule: if you do not know, say "I am not sure, but I think..." and explain your thinking. Never bluff.

HR round: the 6 questions you will hear

Tell me about yourself

Present → past → future, 60-90 seconds. Role, skills, best project, what you want.

Why should we hire you?

Match 2 skills to their job post + one project as proof.

Strengths and weaknesses

Real strength with an example; a real weakness + what you do to fix it.

Where do you see yourself in 5 years?

Growing in this role, learning, taking more responsibility.

Are you ready to relocate / work shifts?

Answer honestly. Decide before the interview.

Do you have any questions?

Always ask one: "What does a fresher learn in the first 3 months here?"

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Record yourself answering "Tell me about yourself" on your phone. Watch it once, improve, record again.

Your 90-Day Plan

From "where do I start?" to applying with confidence in three months.

The plan at a glance

DAYS 1-3 — START

Pick your role

- Read 20 job posts, list top 5 skills

DAYS 4-30 — LEARN

Basics + Project 1

- 2-3 hours a day on core skills
- Finish one small project

DAYS 31-60 — BUILD

Framework + Project 2

- Learn the main tool for your role
- Build a medium project with a database or API

DAYS 61-75 — PROVE

Project 3 + go live

- Real-world project
- Deploy all three, write READMEs

DAYS 76-85 — SHOW

Resume + LinkedIn + GitHub

- ATS resume, profile set-up, pinned projects

DAYS 86-90 — APPLY

Apply daily + prepare

- 10 applications a day
- Aptitude + interview practice

A normal day (3-4 hours)

Time	Do this
1 hour	Learn a new concept (course or docs)
1-2 hours	Build: work on your current project
30 min	Aptitude: 15 questions with a timer
30 min	One coding problem
15 min	LinkedIn: one post or 5 comments

Consistency: 3 focused hours every day beats 12 hours on Sunday.

Already a graduate? run the same plan faster: 60 days, 5 hours a day.

Every Sunday: 15-minute review

- ☐ What did I finish this week?
- ☐ Which day did I skip, and why?
- ☐ Is my project on track for its deadline?
- ☐ Did I push code to GitHub at least 4 days?
- ☐ One thing to do better next week

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Put the 90-day plan on your wall and tick a box every day you follow it.

Apply Smartly + Your Next Step

Treat the job hunt like a project: daily work, tracked, improved.

Where freshers find jobs

Where	How to use it
Naukri, LinkedIn Jobs, Indeed	Set job alerts for your role + city; apply within 24 hours of a post
Company career pages	List 30 companies you like and check them weekly
National hiring tests	Register for off-campus drives and fresher tests from large IT companies
Referrals	Message seniors and LinkedIn connections politely with your resume + one project link
Startups + internships	Wellfound, Internshala, LinkedIn: an internship often turns into a job

Track every application (copy this table)

Company	Role	Applied on	Status	Next step
ABC Tech	Frontend Intern	05 Nov	Test scheduled	Practise aptitude

6 mistakes that keep freshers stuck

- ☐ Learning 5 things at once
- ☐ Copying projects you cannot explain
- ☐ One resume for every job
- ☐ Applying 5 jobs and waiting 2 weeks
- ☐ Skipping aptitude practice
- ☐ Giving up after the first rejections

Referral message (polite + short)

```
Hi [Name], I'm [your name], a [degree]
fresher learning [role]. I saw the
[job title] opening at [company].
I've built [project] ([live link]).
Could you refer me, or tell me what
the team looks for? Resume attached.
Thank you for your time!
```

Weekly job-hunt routine

Day	Do
Mon-Fri	10 tailored applications a day
Tue + Thu	3 referral messages
Wed	Mock interview with a friend
Sat	Aptitude test with a timer
Sun	Update tracker + resume

Want every step in detail? The **TechDrew Placement Ready Box** has a day-by-day 90-day plan, 3 ATS resume templates, a 10-day LinkedIn + GitHub kit, 200 aptitude questions and 100 tech interview questions with flow-diagram answers. TechDrew also runs project-based internships in Full Stack, UI/UX, AI and Data Analytics (15 days, 1 month, 3 months) with mentor guidance and a certificate.

TODAY'S UPDATE ✓ Rejections are normal. Every "no" tells you which round to practise next. Keep going!